Mostaq Ahmad was deeply involved in the coup from the very beginning. Although, there were a handful of young army officers who were directly involved in chalking out the whole plan with clock-like precision, the real brain behind [it] was Pakistan and the CIA. Due to the complacency of the three heads of the defence forces and also other senior and trusted officers of the army [the] coup could be staged. Mostaq Ahmad, according to Dhar, was [a] cunning and scheming fellow but he lacked the personality of Sheikh Mujib. Dhar said it was a fact that pro-Pak elements were jubilant at the turn of events and had started stirring up communal and anti-India propaganda. In the first cabinet meeting, Dhar made some plain speaking. He had told the President Mostaq Ahmad that all the Ministers were also close colleagues of Sheikh

Mujib and as such, they couldn't deny their responsibilities in whatever had happened in Bangladesh under Sheikh Mujib. It is necessary, however, to take action against corrupt people but there should be no witch hunting as a matter of state principle. It is not that easy to obliterate the name of Sheikh Mujib and the slogan 'Jai Bangla' from the minds of people.

As far as suspicions of Chinese involvement were concerned, officials were worried. There was a telegram from the USA where the Chinese representative had made a statement about the Bangladesh situation. China had raised the issue of sharing the waters of the river Ganges while justifying the coup. The Chinese statement read:

We sympathise with the situation of Bangladesh and support its just position. As Ganges is an international river, the upper and lower riparian should conduct consultations on an equal footing for an equitable distribution and utilisation of the water